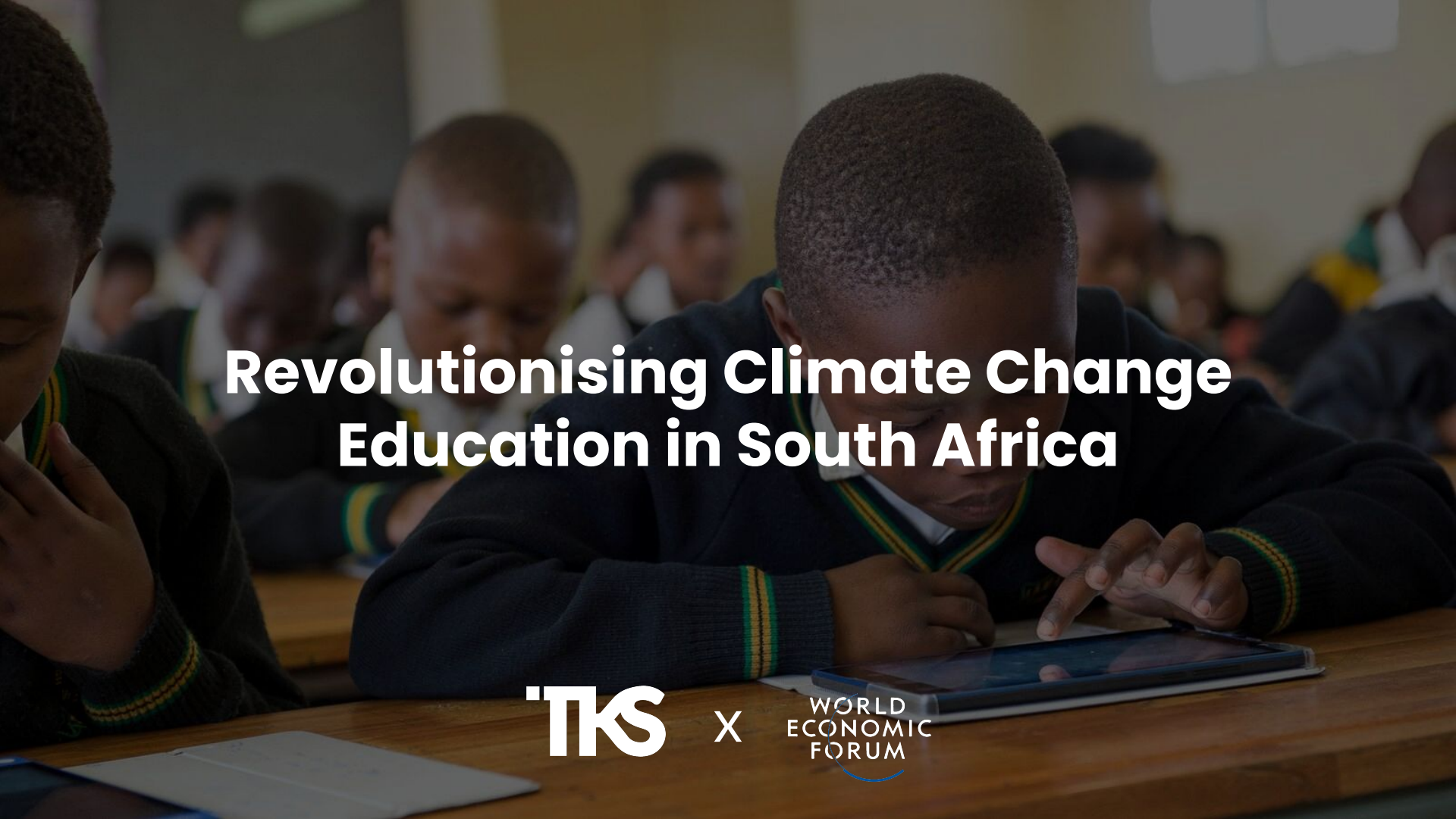

Revolutionising Climate Change Education in South Africa
TKS
X
WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM

Executive Summary

Problem

South Africa is in urgent need of climate change education

South Africa is currently experiencing dire effects of climate change impacting its economy and citizens.

However over **81%** of South African secondary students **lack an understanding** of climate change, regarding its **systemic implications, local relevance,** and **current developments** due to the **shortcomings in** the **education** system.

This lack of understanding **hinders** students ability to take **meaningful climate action** and adapt to the changes caused by climate change.

Solution

Integrate Climate Education into Life Orientation curriculum

Revamp the mandatory 8th grade Life Orientation curriculum through integrating our **online learning platform WE-Think** to provide climate change education.

Via **project based learning** students gain a local contextualisation of climate change and its systemic implications.

Using **thinking journals** we track a learners progress and **enhance critical thinking.**

At the end of the year the learners **present** their project to class fostering a collaborative learning experience.

Impact

Empowering 1.1M South African Students with Climate Education

Post 12 months of national expansion

+ 1 166 600 students will have an **understanding of climate change** and have built projects researching its local relevance instilling a culture in South Africa that cares about the climate and can proactively adapt to the impacts of climate change.

Throughout the year students will have developed skills such as; **critical thinking, systems analysis, environmental stewardship**, etc. Equipping them to understand other global issues.

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01

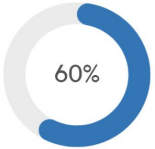
Problem

Problem

South Africa's Climate Crisis: An Urgent Call to Action

With rising temperatures, dwindling water supplies, and increasing climate-related deaths, South Africa faces severe consequences if it doesn't shift away from its high-emissions trajectory. Urgent action is needed to safeguard the nation's people, economy, and future sustainability.

South Africa is already experiencing the dire impacts of climate change through droughts, floods, and scorching heat waves. And it’s only going to get worse:



- Estimates suggest a potential **decrease of surface water supply by 60%** by 2070.
- **Mean annual temperatures** in the country have **increased by twice the global average** (0.7°C).

South Africa will face worsening impacts if it continues with high-emissions:

South africa is **the most coal-dependant nation** in the world and the **highest emitter of CO2 in Africa.**

Between 1990 and 2015, climate change accounted for half of all **heat-related deaths** in the country. By 2050, floods will expose **hundreds of thousands** more people, costing the economy **$742 million**. By 2100, heat-related deaths will surge **25 times higher** than in 1990, with longer heat waves threatening South Africa’s agriculture sector, burning up **$105 million** in growth.

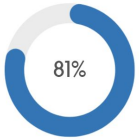


Problem

Status-quo: Climate Change Awareness Among SA Students

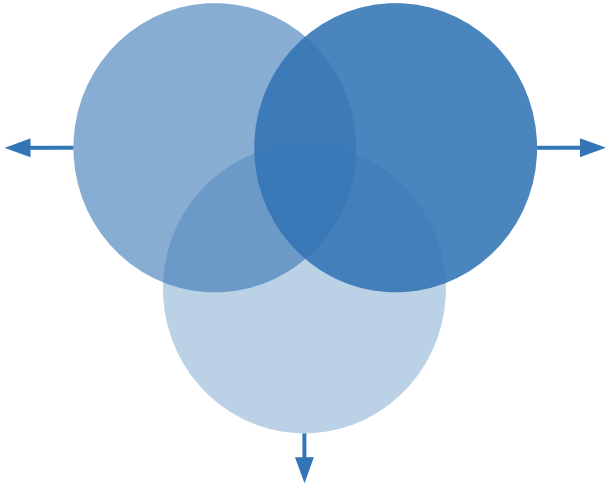
Our research of 50 South African students uncovered three critical challenges in climate change understanding: a lack of systemic comprehension, limited local contextualization, and low awareness of current mitigation efforts.

Systemic Understanding

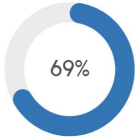


81% of students were unable to articulate how climate change impacted food insecurity.

Students primarily **perceive climate change issues in isolation**, with **only 18% demonstrating an understanding** of its impacts on ecosystems.



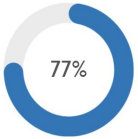
Local Contextualization



69% could **not explain** how climate change **impacts their local community.**

Over 60% of students **don't understand the role of South Africa** in climate change

Awareness of Status-quo



77% of students were **unaware of any current developments** in combating climate change, highlighting a lack of exposure to ongoing efforts.

To see the self-conducted research on South African Students

Click Here

Problem

The Problem: Lack of Awareness about Climate Change amongst South Africans

South Africans face challenges due to a lack of understanding about climate change, hindering their ability to grasp its implications and adapt to its impacts. The education system's deficiencies contribute to this gap, emphasizing the need for urgent climate education reforms.

Lack of Understanding climate change leads to:

01

Inability to grasp the implications of climate change

Without the understanding of implications of climate change, people underestimate the risks and fail to take appropriate action to mitigate and adapt to climate change. This lack of awareness leads to complacency and inaction, hindering efforts to address the challenges effectively.

02

Not knowing how to adapt to the impacts of climate change

Climate change is already affecting various aspects of daily life, including water resources, agriculture, health, and infrastructure. Without knowledge of how to adapt to these impacts, individuals and communities may struggle to cope with changing conditions, leading to increased vulnerability and exposure to risks.

The major cause of this lack of awareness is **the gap that exist within the current education system**

- **Over half** of South African secondary students feel their high-schools are **not adequately teaching** them the soft skills that they need to understand global issues like climate change.
- WEF ranked the **quality of education** in South Africa **137th** out of **139 countries.**
- Climate change as a topic is **never** introduced in the classroom.

Problem

South Africa's urgent need for Climate Change Education

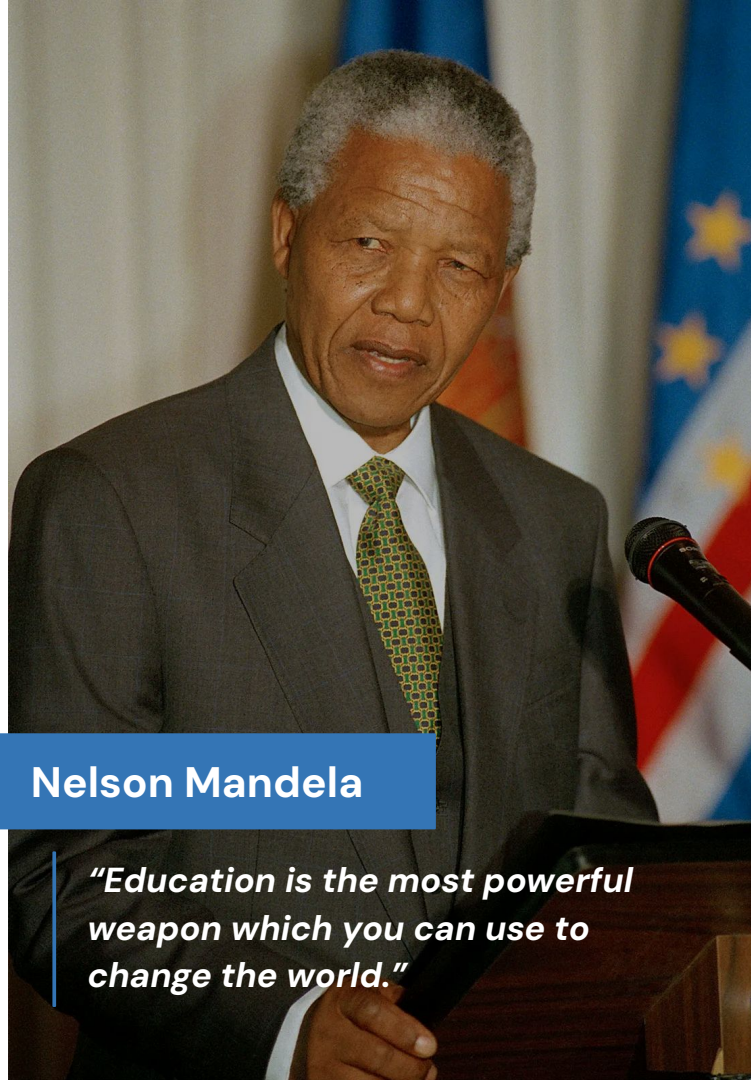
Educating youth about climate change empowers them with the knowledge and tools to take meaningful action. By understanding climate change, young people can become advocates for environmental conservation.

A high interest from students to engage and learn about climate change

- The South African youth have a high-level of concern about climate change with **76% considering it a very important issue to learn about** indicates a strong interest and readiness to engage with the topic.
- **80% of young people** in south africa have been **directly affected** by climate or environment-related events.

Importance of Climate Change Education amongst Youth

- Climate change education **encourages critical thinking** and **problem-solving skills** essential **for addressing complex environmental challenges**. Youth learn to analyze scientific evidence, evaluate the credibility of information, and **develop innovative solutions** to **mitigate and adapt to climate change**.
- Climate education builds **environmental stewardship**, instilling a deep sense of **responsibility for safeguarding natural resources and biodiversity**. By understanding the value of ecosystems and practicing sustainability, youth cultivate a **culture of environmental respect and care**.



Nelson Mandela

> ***"Education is the most powerful weapon which you can use to change the world."***

Problem

Climate Change: Through the Eyes of an Eighth Grader

Zanokuhle's experience emphasizes the urgent need to integrate comprehensive climate change education into school curricula.

Zanokuhle has never been formally introduced to the topic of climate change in the classroom.

Despite that she stated:

> *"I think climate change is really important seeing that'll affect us so much in the future."*

However she could not explain how climate is linked to food insecurity.

When asked to list some current developments in climate change she said:

> *"I can't think of any".*

Zanokuhle has been literate since age 7, attends a private school, and has access to the internet. She believes that climate change is an important issue yet she has a huge gap in her understanding of it.

This suggests the need for improved education of climate change in schools.



Problem

Current Educational Landscape: Opportunity in Life Orientation

By harnessing modern tools and approaches within the Life Orientation curriculum, South Africa can reshape student attitudes towards education and equip them with the knowledge and skills needed to address pressing global issues like climate change.

What is Life Orientation?

In South Africa, "Life Orientation" (L.O.) is a mandatory subject for all grades which is the the study of development of self in society with the 4 aspects of: social & environmental responsibility, democracy, career choices, and physical education.

This **gap in the South African education** signifies an **opportunity to use modern tools** to help students **understand climate change** (and other global problems) **through** the **L.O.** curriculum.

Students Perspective

> *"I basically just see L.O. as a waste of time, 'cause you don't learn anything from it. Maybe if we actually learnt something useful instead the same stuff every year it'd be better."*
>
> *"The most useless subject, so much unnecessary work. I mean universities don't even count it in your APS score so what's the point."*
>
> *"I actually enjoy L.O. as it is a free period to do homework in or catch up on some sleep."*

Teachers Perspective

> *"The problem is the teachers. You see no one sets out to be an L.O. teacher you kind of just get stuck with it. And you don't have time to familiarise yourself with the topics taught and have no passion for it... There's an opportunity here to develop some important skills however having the teachers as the main source of knowledge to the students is why L.O. is unsuccessful. "*



Kelsey Van Wyk
L.O. Teacher at South African High-School

02

Solution

Solution

Revamping the 8th Grade Life Orientation Curriculum with WE-Think

By integrating WE-Think into the 8th grade Life Orientation curriculum, students engage in a comprehensive learning. This approach fosters deep understanding, critical thinking, and collaboration, empowering students to address real-world climate change challenges in their local communities.



WE-Think, our innovative online learning platform, offers meticulously curated content focused on climate change, providing students with a comprehensive educational experience tailored to address pressing environmental challenges.

01

Term 1
Discover

Through our **online learning platform** students will explore different topics related to climate change. The use of **thinking journals** enhances their understanding working through the modules.

02

Term 2
Research

Using **project-based learning** students will select a topic from one of the modules to conduct research on how this aspect of climate change impacts their local community.

03

Term 3
Analyse & Document

Document their findings and analyse them by doing a research report. Draw conclusions from the data collected and present possible solutions to the problem at hand.

04

Term 4
Present

Finally students present their years work to the class, showcasing everything they have learnt creating a collaborative learning experience.

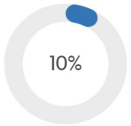
Solution

Integrating WE-Think into the 8th Grade Curriculum: A Strategic Approach

Embedding WE-Think into the 8th-grade curriculum is crucial for engaging students effectively and addressing climate change, leveraging the grade's curriculum flexibility, South Africa's educational mandate, and students' developmental readiness.

Why build into curriculum?

There is **no incentive** for students to engage with our educational solution **unless it is built into the curriculum.** Without the pressure of grades or a structured learning environment, students procrastinate or abandon educational courses altogether.



We see that Udemy courses only have a completion rate of **LESS than 10%**.

This is particularly true for the topic climate change, where the urgency of the issue may not be immediately apparent to all learners.

See our detailed curriculum year plan

Click Here

Why 8th grade?

01

Flexible curriculum:
The higher the grade the more rigorous of a process to make changes to the national curriculum. 8th grade presents itself to be one of the most flexible curriculums.

02

Education Mandate in South Africa:
In South Africa attending school is only **mandatory up to 9th grade**. By introducing the solution at the 8th-grade, it ensures that a significant portion of the students will engage with WE-Think.

03

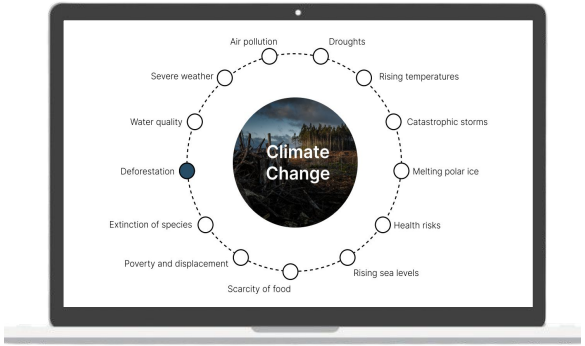
Age-appropriateness:
The age range of 13 - 14 years old represents a critical developmental stage. Sudents are not only receptive to new ideas but are also at a level of **maturity** where they can critically engage with complex concepts.



Solution

Discover: Content Module Creation and Structure

Each module in our curriculum delves into the causation, impact, and individual responsibility regarding environmental issues, fostering comprehensive understanding and empowering South African citizens to enact positive change.



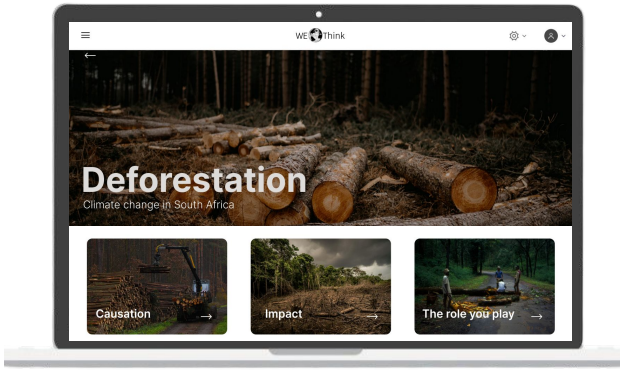
Our curriculum encompasses 13 modules: Air Pollution, Severe Weather, Water Quality, Deforestation, Extinction of Species, Poverty and Displacement, Scarcity of Food, Rising Sea Levels, Increased Droughts, Health Risks, Melting Polar Ice, Catastrophic Storms and Rising Temperatures, each meticulously designed to delve into the causation, impact, and individual responsibility regarding critical environmental issues, drawing insights from UN reports, research papers, and online courses to ensure comprehensive coverage.

Each module will consist of

01 **Causation:** Understanding the root causes of the environmental issue.

02 **Impact:** Exploring the consequences and effects of the issue on ecosystems, communities, and individuals.

03 **The Role You Play as a South African Citizen:** Empowering individuals to take action and make a positive difference in addressing the environmental challenges.



Solution

Collaborative Video Module Development

Engaging 50-minute video modules, developed in collaboration with global and local experts, provide immersive learning experiences tailored to South African environmental concerns, fostering meaningful engagement.

Video-Based Learning Experience

Modules will be delivered through engaging video content, providing an immersive learning experience for viewers.

Each module, carefully crafted to captivate and inform, will run for approximately **50 minutes**. This duration allows for **in-depth exploration** of the environmental topic at hand while ensuring **sustained viewer engagement** throughout the educational session.



Development through Partnership

To develop the video modules, we're collaborating with experts globally and locally.
Three global partners contribute international perspectives, enriching the content with diverse insights. Simultaneously, **three local partners provide context-specific knowledge** tailored to South African environmental concerns. These collaborations ensure that our content resonates effectively with the audience.

Solution

WE-Think Content Partnerships: Global and Local Expert Collaborations

Local



Shamini Harrington

With extensive experience in emissions reduction and global climate policy negotiations, Shamini enriches WE-Think's content with industry insights and nuanced perspectives on climate challenges.

For contact details

Click Here



Raeesah Noor Mahomed

Raeesah's commitment to decolonizing activism and grassroots advocacy brings invaluable perspectives to WE-Think's content, fostering inclusivity and empowering students to drive positive change.

For contact details

Click Here



Bruce Hewitson

As a lead researcher in climate dynamics and regional projections, Bruce's expertise ensures that WE-Think's content is grounded in scientific rigor and accessible to students of diverse backgrounds.

For contact details

Click Here

Global



Paul Block

Paul's expertise in water resources management and disaster preparedness enriches WE-Think's content with insights into climate adaptation and resilience-building strategies for vulnerable communities.

For contact details

Click Here



Peter Adams

Peter's research on air quality and climate dynamics enhances WE-Think's content with a focus on environmental health and the impacts of human activities on the atmosphere.

For contact details

Click Here



Joseph E. Aldy

With expertise in climate policy and governance, Joseph's contributions align WE-Think's content with international agreements and equip students with the knowledge to advocate for effective climate action.

For contact details

Click Here

Solution

WE-Think Highlights: Keeping our content up-to-date

Our AI solution, "Highlights," ensures students stay updated on current affairs in climate change.

We address the lack of current affairs knowledge on climate change among learners by establishing a dedicated hub on our platform called "**Highlights**". Here, users can conveniently preview relevant content sourced from the internet.

This proactive approach **ensures that WE-Think remains up-to-date** by leveraging AI to curate this centralized repository of current climate content.

Modeled after the format used by the WEF forum, the previews will offer a similar layout as shown:



Key Features of Our AI Solution

01 **Real Time Updates:** The AI continuously updates information from various sources, ensuring students receive the latest insights on climate change.

02 **Transparency:** Providing transparent content sourcing of the information presented. Each piece of content includes detailed about its origin. Students can then make informed judgments about the information they encounter.

03 **Engagement:** Foster student engagement by delivering content that is relevant and in an engaging manner. Tailoring content to students' interests the AI sparks curiosity and encourages exploration of climate change topics.

Promoting Engagement Through Integrated Assessment and Discussion

To incentivise engagement with this hub, we propose incorporating it into the assessment structure. Each term students will participate in a *'climate current affairs*' discussion facilitated by the teacher revolving highlights, allowing learners to share their insights/opinions on recent developments.

Solution

Project-Based Learning Journey

Within our solution, we provide a project for students to delve into the complexities of climate change. From choosing a topic to conducting localized research, documenting findings, engaging in peer review, and reflecting on outcomes.

01

Topic Selection and Research Planning

Students will work through modules on the WE-Think platform and **select one of their interest**.

They will then **brainstorm potential project ideas** as to how they would conduct research in of this topic's impact in their local community.

Students will **develop a detailed research plan** outlining goals, deadlines, and milestones for their project.

Skills developed:

- Curiosity
- Critical Thinking

02

Conducting Localized Research

Students will **execute their research plan** and begin gathering information and data related to their chosen consequence from their local community.

They will utilize methods such as interviews, surveys, and observations to collect firsthand insights and perspectives. Students will document their research process and reflect on their progress, noting any adjustments or refinements to their initial plan.

Skills developed:

- Initiative
- Adaptability
- Empathy
- Civic Responsibility

Solution

Example of Projects

Student Research Planning Sample

To view Zanokuhle's research planning program, written by following our thinking journal prompts

Click Here

Student Project Documentation Sample

To view Zanokuhle's documentation sample

Click Here

Student Project Documentation Template

To view a general project documentation template

Click Here

03

Documenting Findings

During this step, students will summarise their research findings in the form of a research report . They will provide **context, analysis, and recommendations** based on their localized research.

Students will translate their findings into a clear, concise, and compelling narrative, supported by evidence and examples **analysing their data** and **presenting a solution** for the problem investigated.

Skills developed:

- Systems analysis
- Environmental stewardship
- Problem solving

04

Conducting Localized Research

Students will participate in **peer review** sessions, providing **constructive feedback to their classmates** and incorporating suggestions into their revisions.

They will revise and refine their documentation based on peer feedback, ensuring clarity, coherence, and persuasiveness.

Skills developed:

- Communication
- Growth Mindset
- Collaboration

Solution

Case Study: Project Based Learning

Examining the impact of Project-Based Learning (PBL) through the Buck Institute for Education (BIE) reveals significant increases in student motivation, engagement, and academic performance compared to traditional teaching methods.

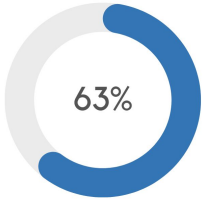
The Buck Institute for Education (BIE) is a nonprofit that helps teachers use project-based learning (PBL) in their classrooms. PBL is a teaching method where students learn by working independently on engaging projects. BIE provides resources and support to make PBL easier for teachers to implement.

> *"PBL environments lead to increased student motivation and engagement. Students are better able to apply what they know to new situations and, seeing a real-world impact gives them a sense of agency and purpose."*

Research findings reveal that almost half of the students enrolled in project-based classrooms successfully passed their AP tests, surpassing their counterparts in traditional classrooms by 8 percentage points.

BUCK INSTITUTE FOR EDUCATION

PBLworks



Schools incorporating PBL environment through BIE see 63% **greater gains in student performance** than their previous traditional teaching method.

Solution

Present: End of year assessment through presentation

Our end-of-year assessment method emphasizes strategic planning, real-time reflection, peer learning, and skill development. By engaging in a systematic process of conveying their project presentations, students develop critical thinking, communication, adaptability, and presentation skills, fostering a collaborative learning environment.

How will it work?

01 **Strategic Planning:** Students deliberately and thoughtfully map out their presentations in advance by engaging in a systematic process of conveying their project presentations

02 **Real-time Reflection:** During presentations, students are encouraged to reflect on the evolution of their thinking processes over the course of the year

03 **Peer Learning:** Students have the opportunity to observe and learn from each other's presentations, gaining exposure to diverse perspectives on climate change.

> *"What works well is rather than having a teacher in front of a student transferring their knowledge vertically, each individual is going to become a source of knowledge for their peers around them transferring knowledge horizontally."*



Brittany Bir
Former COO of 42 programming schools in Silicon Valley

Skills developed

- **Critical Thinking:** Analyzing data and diverse perspectives builds informed decision-making
- **Communication:** Articulating ideas persuasively enhances verbal and nonverbal skills
- **Adaptability:** Responding to feedback cultivates flexibility and confidence
- **Presentation Skills:** Practicing delivery techniques to convey narratives with professionalism

To see the Rubric for assessment

Click Here

Solution

Enhancing Critical Thinking with Thinking Journals

Thinking Journals, inspired by the KWL chart, prompt students to reflect on what they know, learn, and want to know about climate change. Research shows that they enhance critical thinking, problem-solving, and motivation.

Research behind thinking journals

- **76%** of students who used thinking journals demonstrated reflection and were able to relate their experiences and turn them into new learning opportunities.
- Studies show that activating prior knowledge **enhances learning retention** by up to **40%**
- Reflective practices have been linked to improved **critical thinking,** problem-solving, and **metacognition**.

> *"It is important to encourage students to ask questions and reflect, rather than simply providing them answers. It helps them make conscious, wise decisions and truly understand things on their own."*



Liz Keable
Founder of Learning Pockets & Metacognition Specialist

To view sample thinking journal prompts

Click Here

K

What do I KNOW?

Purpose: Encourages students to activate prior knowledge and articulate their current understanding of climate change.
Example: "Reflect on what you already know about climate change and its impact on the world. List down key facts, concepts, or ideas."

W

What do I WANT to know?

Purpose: Stimulates curiosity guiding students to identify specific areas for exploration.
Example: "Identify areas or topics related to climate change that you are curious about and would like to explore further. What questions do you have?"

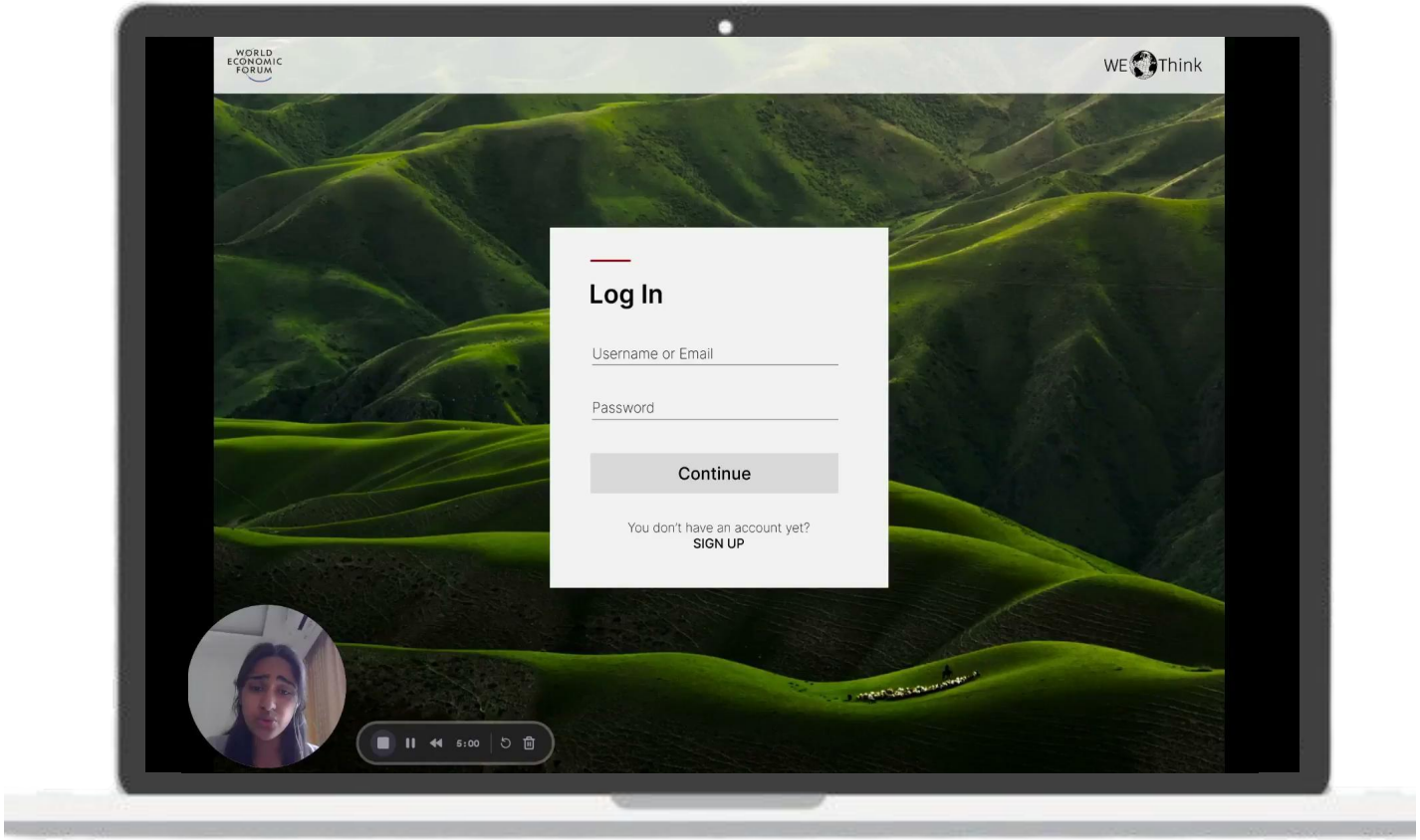
L

What did I LEARN?

Purpose: Promotes reflection and synthesis, prompting students to articulate newly acquired insights.
Example: "After engaging with the online modules, summarize what you have learned about climate change. What new insights or perspectives have you gained?"

Solution

Product Overview: A Walkthrough



Solution

What experts are saying

> *"Empowering South African youth with knowledge about climate change is not just an educational goal; it's a necessary step for sustainable development. By integrating WE-Think climate education into our curriculum, we're not only enlightening minds but also cultivating a generation of informed and proactive individuals who can lead the charge in creating a more sustainable and resilient future for South Africa and the world."*



Lindiwe Matlali

WEF Global Frontier Council
Founder of Africa Teen Geeks

For more validation

Click Here

03

Execution

Execution

Implementation Plan Overview

Months 1-3

Pre-Platform Development

Target: Ensuring a smooth transition by handing over the curriculum, initiating planning sessions, and commencing platform development while also reaching out to experts to engage in content creation for the platform.

Months 4-6

Planning & Preparation

Target: Equipping Curro schools stakeholders with the knowledge and resources necessary for successful project based learning and platform adoption.

Months 7-8

Pilot Implementation

Target: Testing PBL effectiveness in select Curro schools through pilot projects in L.O. classes in order to evaluate pilot outcomes and gathering of feedback to refine strategies for wider implementation.

Months 9-10

Scaling Up

Target: Expansion of PBL implementation across all Curro schools, provision of ongoing support, and monitoring of progress. Ensuring consistent access to PBL across participating schools and assessment of its impact.

Months 10-11

Sustainability and Continuous Improvement

Target: Embedding of PBL into Curro school culture, fostering continuous improvement and sharing of best practices. Aiming for ongoing professional development.

Months 12+

Future Growth

Target: Continuation of enhancement of PBL practices and exploration of opportunities for further expansion and collaboration.

To learn more

Click Here

Execution

Implementation Through CURRO Schools

Leveraging Curro's existing technology integration and diverse student population presents a scalable opportunity to implement innovative educational solutions across South Africa.

Why Curro?

01 **Current use of technology in education**
All Curro schools already use tablets in the classroom making our platform easily integratable.

02 **Access to a Diverse Student Population**
Curro schools boast a diverse student body, offering valuable insights from various demographics.

03 **Expansion Potential**
Curro's network of schools provides a scalable springboard for piloting and expanding the learning platform

What is Curro?

Curro is a network of private schools known for its innovative approach to education across South Africa.

68 high-schools across South Africa with over **30 000** high-school **students**

*"We're always looking for new innovative ways to improve education. So in principle if a tool such as this were developed **I find it highly likely it would be adopted into our curriculum** across all schools."*



Bradley Neal
Head of Life Orientation
At Curro Hillcrest High-School

Execution

National Expansion: Integrating WE-Think into SA's Education System

Partnering with DBE (Department of Basic Education), we propose integrating WE-Think into SA's education system. Beginning with private schools like Curro, we aim to prove effectiveness before transitioning to public schools.

Proposal to DBE

Propose partnership and WE-Think platform to Granville Whittle (*Chief Directorate for Partnerships and Enrichment Educational Services at DBE*).

Evaluation of Standards by DBE

Discussions with DBE representatives to assess compliance with standards of accessibility, data privacy and alignment with national curriculum objectives.

Collaboration on Piloting Plan

Coordinate with Simone Geyer (*Chief Directorate for Implementation Monitoring and Support at DBE*), to create a piloting plan.

Post Pilot adjustment

Analyse feedback and data collected during the piloting phase to make necessary adjustments to WE-think.

WE-Think will be built into the national curriculum expecting all schools in South Africa to integrate it.

For contact details

Click Here

Starting with private schools and moving to public model

South African student enrollment:



Most potential impact in public schools however: change in public curriculum is a lengthy process

Strategy: Prove success of WE-Think in private schools (*starting with Curro*) to demonstrate effectiveness/feasibility, making national curriculum changes more likely to be considered for implementation in broader public education.

Case study: Curriculum change through collaboration with Africa Teen Geeks

African Teen Geeks is an external WEF-supported organisation that has collaborated with the DBE to introduce coding and robotics education into the national curriculum.

To read more

Click Here

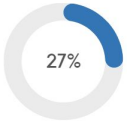
Execution

Addressing Challenges in National Expansion

Overcoming accessibility challenges through mobilizing WE-Think for mobile devices and addressing language barriers with auto-generated translations ensures meaningful engagement.

01

Accessibility Standards

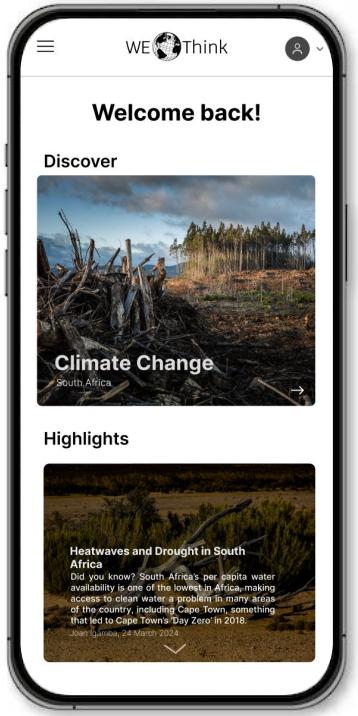


27% South Africans have **access to a computer.**



There is 95% **mobile access** penetration in South Africa.

Solution:
Mobilisation of the WE-Think platform



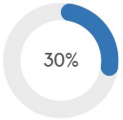
02

Language Barrier

The language of instruction for all schools beyond 4th grade is English.

However some rural schools are exempt from this having no fluent english-speaking teachers. (+- 500 000 high-school students are affected by this)

The learning journey must be tailored for these schools so that they can still engage with the content meaningfully.



Students see 30% increase in understanding when taught in their home language.

Solution:
Auto-generated translations of content into Zulu, Xhosa, Afrikaans, Tswana and Swati.

Execution

Financial Breakdown

The financial breakdown outlines costs for website and content development, training and marketing, pilot initiatives, and ongoing maintenance. Initial investment focuses on platform establishment and partnerships, followed by training and marketing efforts. Pilot initiatives and feedback surveys guide further development and expansion, ensuring sustainable integration.

	1	2	3	4	5
Stage	**Website and content development**	**Training and marketing**	**Pilot**	**First 6 months**	**Regular expansion**
Time	5 months	3 months	1 year	6 months	
Key objectives	Establish the platform and finalize partnerships.	Train the teachers and market platform to Curro	Implement the finalized content partnerships, launch platform and start preparing for feedback	Have a pilot initiative ready, send out feedback surveys (found in our recommendation) and get on board with more schools	Establish feedback surveys, monitor progress and continue objectives of the Pilot and the first 6 months. Further develop platform based on feedback.
Website Development	$300,000				
Maintenance cost		$14,375 ($57,500 annually)	$57,500	$28,750	$57,500
Curriculum Development	$256,559				(may add on when further localizing the in different countries)
Total Costs	$556,559	$14,375	$57,500	$28,750	

For details of all estimation and assumptions

Click Here

Execution

WE-Think Funding: Self-Funded or Monetized?

WEF can either self-fund the WE-Think platform, ensuring control and independence, or opt for user-based pricing for financial sustainability. Each option has implications for control, accessibility, and long-term viability.

01 Option A: Self-Funding by WEF

In this option, the World Economic Forum (WEF) takes on the responsibility of funding the development, implementation, and maintenance of the WE-Think platform using its own financial resources. This approach offers WEF complete control over the platform's operations and strategic direction without relying on external sources of revenue.

- WEF solely finances the platform's development and operations.
- This ensures independence from external funding sources, allowing WEF to maintain control over all aspects of platform management.
- WEF can prioritize features and initiatives based on its organizational goals and objectives without external influence.

For details of pricing method

Click Here

02 Option B: Monetization Strategy

In this option, the WE-Think platform is monetized through user based pricing. Revenue generated from these sources helps offset development and maintenance costs, ensuring the platform's financial sustainability over the long term.

Pricing Strategy:

- **Pilot Testing Phase →** Cost per student for pilot testing approximately $19.03, thus offering a rate of $20 per student.
- **Full Rollout →** Considering parents' affordability at around $3,200 per student, pricing the full rollout at $50 per student is suggested, covering costs and allowing scalability.

In pilot testing, we only have Curro, a private school where the per-student head fee can be given by each parent. However, in the full rollout, when we include public sector schools, the school fees are fixed and cannot be changed. In such cases, a certain portion of government budget may need to be allocated to cover the costs of platform implementation.

This adjustment ensures equitable access to the platform for all students, regardless of their economic background or school type.

Execution

Expansion of WE-Think: To other issues & countries

WE-Think's adaptable model can extend beyond climate change to address various global issues.. Additionally, our platform aims for global reach by collaborating with education ministries to integrate tailored content into diverse educational systems worldwide.

Expansion to other global problems

The platform is a **repeatable model** that once proven successful can be scaled to **address other pressing global issues** beyond climate change, following the same format of research, analysis, and action. Enhancing the understanding of global issues in a local contextualisation, systemic understanding and awareness of the status-quo. This could include topics such as Youth Safety, World hunger, Water scarcity, and more.

In South Africa they could have a continuation of their 8th grade L.O. project into 9th grade where they could focus on other global problems or implement some of the solutions they identified in 8th grade.

Expansion to other countries

We aim to globalize our platform, providing education on pressing global issues worldwide. Through collaboration with education ministers, we can seamlessly integrate WE-Think into international education systems and curricula. By tailoring the content with local experts on the topic to meet the needs of that country's education.

For a sample of 9th grade curriculum

Click Here



04

Impact

30 076 [1]

Students reached after 12 months in Curro Schools

1 116 600 [2]

Students reached after 12 months national expansion

Impact

Long-Term Outcomes

Integrating project-based learning in Curro schools cultivates critical skills, empowering students to address global issues beyond climate change. This initiative aligns with WEF's mission by fostering future leaders equipped to advocate for sustainable development and contribute to global dialogues.

01

Cultivating skills to understand other global problems

Throughout the year students will have developed the skills of;

Curiosity, Critical Thinking, Initiative, Adaptability, Empathy, Civic Responsibility, Systems analysis, environmental stewardship, problem solving, collaboration, communication, growth mindset.

Equipping them with the thought patterns they would need to understand other global issues.

02

Developing Environmentally conscious students

Through PBL it will make students proactive against climate change and inspire meaningful climate action. This approach not only enhances their understanding of environmental issues but also cultivates a generation of environmentally conscious leaders.

Why WEF should care about this?

WEF's top objective is to facilitate dialogue on pressing global issues leading to the shaping of global agendas.

We know that climate change disproportionately affects developing countries, so it's important that these countries have a seat at the table in this dialogue.

Empowering the next generation of leaders in South Africa not only ensures that they are well-equipped to shape policies and advocate for change within their own nation but also cultivates a collective consciousness regarding environmental concerns. This ensures accurate representation of their perspectives on the global stage.

Impact

Using KPIs to evaluate progress

Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) provide valuable insights into student engagement, learning outcomes, teacher support, community involvement, climate change impact, platform effectiveness, and expansion. By monitoring these metrics, we can assess progress and effectiveness, guiding continuous improvement efforts.

01 **Student Engagement Metrics:** During pilot testing 30, 127 number of active users on the platform and 35 hours of platform usage per student based on class time

02 **Learning Outcomes:** Improvement in assessment scores and in critical thinking skills

03 **Teacher Feedback and Support:** Teacher satisfaction survey and number of teachers actively utilizing the platform

04 **Community Engagement:** Participation rates in community-building activities and feedback from community stakeholders

05 **Impact on Climate Change Awareness and Action:** Student perceptions and motivation administered through focus groups

06 **Platform Effectiveness and Accessibility:** Measured through user satisfaction surveys, accessibility metrics and the feedback on usefulness of platform features

07 **Expansion and Reach:** Number of new regions or schools adopting the platform and growth in user base

Teacher Satisfaction Survey

Click Here

User Satisfaction Survey

Click Here

All the Tiny Details You Might Need: Additional Research & Playbooks

- Platform Overview
- Thinking Journals
- AI Highlights
- Curriculum Plan
- Partnerships
- Qualitative Support
- Project Based Learning
- Assessment Rubrics
- Financial Breakdown
- Monetisation Strategy
- Implementation
- National Expansion

You can find **ALL** our playbooks & resources in our challenge hub:

Challenge Hub

L'chelle Bester



Jhanvi Matta



Maryam Imran



Deniz Karadağ



Thank you, WEF!

It's been an enlightening and exhilarating journey for us to learn alongside you. Tackling such a formidable challenge is commendable, and we're truly grateful for the chance to contribute our insights. We hope that our recommendations prove to be valuable in your endeavors!